

Young fruit

Coconuts start off as green fruit and take about a year to ripen on the tree. Eventually, their stems break, and the heavy fruits fall to the ground. The coconut seed is hidden inside the fruit. Some germinate where they fall, while others are carried off by the waves.

Flowering

The tree produces flowers when it is around seven years old. Insects feed on the sweet nectar and pollinate the flowers, which then develop into fruits.

Growing up

By the time it is 20 years old, the coconut palm is fully grown and 100 ft (30 m) tall. Up to 40 feather-like leaves, called fronds, grow in a “crown” from a single bud at the top of the trunk.

Coconut palm

A coconut palm’s seeds are contained in its coconuts. The seeds are spread not by air or on the backs of animals, but with the help of the sea.

Coconuts are often washed into the water and then drift on ocean currents to beaches far away.

The yellow flowers bloom all year round.

